

The Domain Buying Guide

Choose a great domain and never overpay on renewals.

Part of the free Founder Launch Pack — yours to keep, share, and act on. No strings, no lead farming.

What makes a great domain

- Short and memorable — aim for under 15 characters
- Easy to say out loud and easy to spell
- Brandable over descriptive (Stripe beats online-payments-processing)
- No hyphens, no numbers, no easily-misspelled words
- Future-proof — won't box you in as you grow

.com vs .io vs .ai

.com — most trusted, the default people type. Scarce and pricier for good names.

.io — completely normal for tech and SaaS. Credible with startup-native audiences.

.ai — signals exactly what you'd expect; popular and rising, but renews higher.

The hidden cost: renewals

Registrars love a cheap first-year price, then quietly hike the renewal. Always compare the first-year AND the renewal price. Two providers — Cloudflare and Porkbun — are known for selling at or near cost with no renewal markup.

Provider	1st year (.com)	Renewal	WHOIS privacy
Cloudflare	\$9.77	\$9.77	Free
Porkbun	\$9.13	\$11.06	Free
Namecheap	\$10.28	\$15.88	Free
GoDaddy	\$11.99	\$21.99	Paid add-on

Sample pricing for illustration. Always check live prices before buying.

Buying checklist

- Compare first-year and renewal prices side by side
- Confirm WHOIS privacy is included free
- Watch for checkouts that pre-tick paid add-ons
- Turn on auto-renew so you never lose the domain
- Consider grabbing the .com too if you launch on .io/.ai

Shortcut: the Igotdomain assistant suggests available names from your idea and lays out pricing across providers in one view — free.